

F5 Daily Briefing - Monday, August 24, 2026

Daily competitive intelligence covering 22 F5 competitors

22

COMPETITORS TRACKED

21

ANNOUNCEMENTS

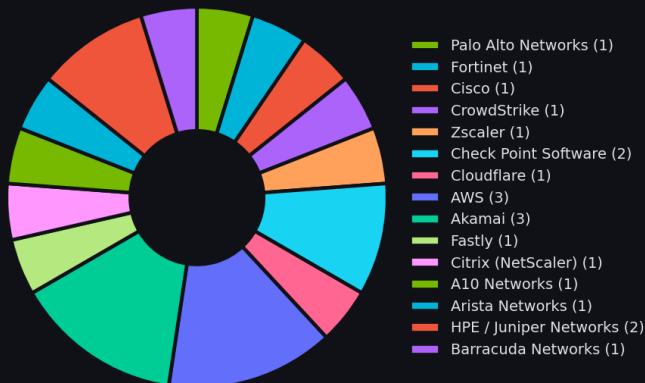
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ACTIVE

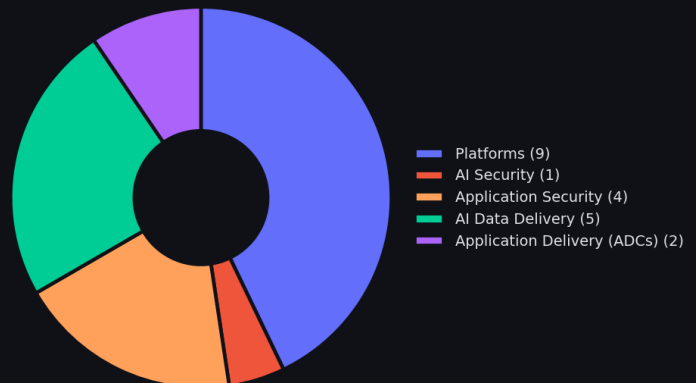
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ACTIVE CATEGORIES

Announcements by Competitor



Announcements by Category



ALL ANNOUNCEMENTS (21)

Partnership **Palo Alto Networks** Mon, Aug 24, 2026

Axis Communications Joins Palo Alto Networks Frontier AI Critical Defense Program as Founding Partner

Axis Communications signed on as a founding partner in Palo Alto Networks' Frontier AI Critical Defense Program, which pushes network-level "virtual patches" to shield critical infrastructure from AI-accelerated exploitation. The arrangement gives operators of Axis edge devices in government, transportation and utility environments protection while official firmware updates are tested and staged, avoiding operational disruption. It extends the program's device-maker roster alongside Siemens, Mitsubishi Electric and IBM/Red Hat, positioning Palo Alto as the enforcement layer for AI-discovered vulnerabilities in OT and IoT fleets.

Source: <https://intlbm.com/2026/08/24/axis-joins-palo-alto-networks-to-curb-software-vulnerabilities/>

Company News **Fortinet** Mon, Aug 24, 2026

Fortinet Launches "Defenders of Digital Bharat" Thought-Leadership Series with CNBC-TV18 in India

Fortinet and CNBC-TV18 launched Defenders of Digital Bharat, a national series on AI, cybersecurity and enterprise resilience, opening in Bengaluru with CIOs and CISOs from HCLTech, Angel One, Mphasis and Zensar. Discussion centered on moving AI from experimentation to business-critical deployment, embedding security across the AI lifecycle, and using AI for threat detection and telemetry analysis. The program targets financial services, healthcare, manufacturing, retail and government buyers, extending Fortinet's platform narrative through regional media rather than a product release.

Source: <https://www.cnbctv18.com/technology/defenders-of-digital-bharat-ai-cybersecurity-and-the-new-rules-of-enterprise-resilience-199759>

Security Advisory **Cisco** Mon, Aug 24, 2026

Cisco Crosswork and Secure Workload Hit by Nine Flaws, Five Rated CVSS 10.0

Cisco's August security hardening release addresses nine vulnerability groupings across Crosswork and Secure Workload, five carrying maximum CVSS 10.0 scores, including authentication bypass, SQL injection, external file-system control, credential exposure and command injection. There are no workarounds; customers must upgrade Crosswork to 7.2.1-SP and Secure Workload to 3.10.9.1 or 4.0.4.16, and update on-premises agents and connectors themselves. Cisco reports no known in-the-wild exploitation, and says it found the flaws through internal testing under a more frequent, AI-accelerated disclosure cadence.

Source: <https://fieldeffect.com/blog/cisco-patches-critical-vulnerabilities-crosswork-secure-workload>

Financial **CrowdStrike** Mon, Aug 24, 2026

Options Market Prices ~8% Swing, About \$15.6B in Market Cap, Ahead of CrowdStrike Q2 Earnings

Ahead of CrowdStrike's fiscal Q2 report on August 26, options pricing implied roughly an 8% post-earnings move, equal to about \$15.6 billion of market capitalization, with shares near \$191. Expectations center on roughly 23% revenue growth and continued ARR expansion driven by AI security demand, following the recent CTO departure and ahead of Fal.Con 2026. The setup underlines how heavily investors now weight AI security attach rates and platform consolidation wins when valuing endpoint-led security platforms.

Source: <https://ts2.tech/en/crowdstrike-options-price-a-15-6-billion-earnings-test-for-ai-security/>

Company News **Zscaler** Mon, Aug 24, 2026

Zscaler Argues Frontier AI Demands More Digital Sovereignty, Extends Zero Trust Exchange for Agentic AI

Zscaler published a position piece arguing frontier AI raises rather than lowers the urgency of digital sovereignty, and described extending the Zero Trust Exchange into a dedicated architecture for frontier and agentic AI covering speed, precision and scale. The company outlined a "5C" execution framework aligned to European sovereignty priorities and pointed to its sovereign Zero Trust SASE service with Schwarz Digits, hosted in STACKIT data centers for EU data residency. Target buyers include public administration, defense, financial services and healthcare.

Source: <https://www.zscaler.com/blogs/company-news/no-contradiction-here-frontier-ai-requires-more-digital-sovereignty-not-less>

Research/Report **Check Point Software** Mon, Aug 24, 2026

Check Point Research Publishes 24 August Threat Intelligence Report

Check Point Research's weekly Threat Intelligence Report details the StopAndProtect campaign abusing thousands of compromised WordPress sites to combine ransomware with data theft via ClickFix, plus a CIOp extortion campaign exploiting CVE-2026-12569 in PTC Windchill and FlexPLM that has hit more than 40 organizations. It also flags education-sector attacks averaging 4,696 weekly attacks per organization in 2026, up 8%. Check Point IPS provides coverage for the PTC remote code execution flaw.

Source: <https://research.checkpoint.com/2026/24th-august-threat-intelligence-report/>

Research/Report **Check Point Software** Mon, Aug 24, 2026

Check Point Research Shows Windows Defender's Own Driver Can Disable Security Controls

Check Point Research disclosed that BTR.sys, a Microsoft-signed Windows Defender Boot-Time Removal component, can be repurposed into a kernel-level operation engine to delete files, modify the registry, and bypass security controls. The technique abuses the driver's legitimate remediation workflow rather than a vulnerability or bring-your-own-vulnerable-driver attack. A proof-of-concept tool, BTR_CLI, crafts encrypted transactions that execute across Windows 7 through Windows 11 25H2, giving attackers privileged startup changes without tripping conventional defenses.

Source: <https://www.csoonline.com/article/4212929/windows-defenders-own-driver-can-leave-systems-defenseless.html>

Security Advisory **Cloudflare** Mon, Aug 24, 2026

Cloudflare Ships Five WAF Managed Rule Changes in 24 August Release

Cloudflare's scheduled WAF managed ruleset release for 24 August adds four new detections: HTTP/2 Request Smuggling – Request Body Anomaly, and XSS – JavaScript Event Handler Coercion across headers, body, and URI. A beta XSS/HTML Injection Script Tag rule is merged into the existing production rule. All five ship in Log mode, with the default action moving to Block on the following release day. Zones with a ruleset-level Block override will block the new rules immediately.

Source: <https://developers.cloudflare.com/changelog/post/scheduled-waf-release/>

Company News

AWS

Mon, Aug 24, 2026

AWS Weekly Roundup Highlights Las Vegas Local Zone and Fourth London Availability Zone

AWS's 24 August weekly roundup confirmed general availability of a new Local Zone in Las Vegas supporting EC2 C7i, M7i, R7i, and C8gn instances plus EBS, ECS, EKS, Application Load Balancer, and Direct Connect, expanding Local Zones past 30 metros. The Europe (London) Region gained a fourth Availability Zone, eu-west-2d, adding Trn3 and P6 accelerated capacity for AI/ML workloads. AWS also launched Student Rewards on Builder Center, backed by over \$500 million in training resources.

Source: <https://aws.amazon.com/blogs/aws/aws-weekly-roundup-student-rewards-on-aws-builder-center-local-zone-in-las-vegas-and-more-august-24-2026/>

Product Launch

AWS

Mon, Aug 24, 2026

OpenAI GPT-5.6 Terra and Luna Now Generally Available on Amazon Bedrock in GovCloud

AWS made OpenAI's GPT-5.6 Terra and Luna models generally available on Amazon Bedrock in AWS GovCloud (US-West and US-East), with context windows up to one million tokens. Terra delivers GPT-5.5-level performance at roughly half the cost, while Luna targets lowest-cost inference. Prompt caching with explicit cache breakpoints offers a 90% discount on repeated context across agent workflows, aimed at autonomous coding agents, long-horizon research, and cybersecurity analysis in regulated government environments.

Source: <https://aws.amazon.com/about-aws/whats-new/2026/08/openai-gpt-terra-luna-govcloud/>

Product Launch

AWS

Mon, Aug 24, 2026

AWS Adds New Ray Capabilities to SageMaker HyperPod

AWS introduced new Ray capabilities on Amazon SageMaker HyperPod, integrating the distributed compute framework with HyperPod's purpose-built infrastructure for foundation model training and serving. The capabilities are available in all AWS Regions where SageMaker HyperPod EKS is supported, and AWS published documentation, a getting-started guide, and an interactive demo. The move deepens AWS's control over the orchestration layer for large-scale model training and inference workloads running on Kubernetes.

Source: <https://aws.amazon.com/blogs/machine-learning/introducing-new-ray-capabilities-on-sagemaker-hyperpod/>

Executive Move

Akamai

Mon, Aug 24, 2026

Akamai Appoints Louis Tague to Lead Australia and New Zealand

Akamai named Louis Tague Regional Vice President and Managing Director for Australia and New Zealand, reporting to APAC Managing Director Sean Li. Tague brings over 20 years of enterprise technology sales and leadership experience in the region and will run Akamai's ANZ business as the company pushes for growth after APAC revenues passed \$1 billion. He cited plans to lean on Akamai's combined security, AI, and cloud portfolio while deepening local customer, team, and partner relationships.

Source: <https://itbrief.com.au/story/akamai-names-louis-tague-to-lead-australia-new-zealand>

Product Launch

Akamai

Mon, Aug 24, 2026

Akamai Adds AI Custom Rule Builder Assistant to App & API Protector

Akamai introduced the Custom Rule Builder AI Assistant inside App & API Protector, letting security analysts convert natural-language prompts into enforceable custom WAF rules instead of hand-writing logic. Generated rules are not auto-deployed; analysts must review, edit, and validate them before activation, preserving human oversight. The assistant works in two workflows — Custom Rule Builder for authoring and editing, and Web Security Analytics for turning investigation context directly into mitigations — aiming to shorten the gap between threat detection and active protection.

Source: <https://www.akamai.com/blog/security/closing-gap-detection-protection-ai-custom-rules>

Company News

Akamai

Mon, Aug 24, 2026

Akamai Maps Distributed Cloud Shift for APAC AI Inference Workloads

Akamai outlined a distributed cloud strategy for Asia-Pacific AI workloads moving from pilots to production, arguing inference traffic is dispersed and continuous rather than centralized. The company plans to deploy thousands of NVIDIA Blackwell GPUs across its network and positions Inference Cloud as the first global implementation of NVIDIA AI Grid for orchestrating workloads across edge, regional, and core infrastructure. Akamai also pitched Workforce Protector for AI governance, capturing prompt context, file transfers, and browser-extension risk with allow, warn, redact, or block policies.

Source: <https://itbrief.com.au/story/akamai-maps-distributed-cloud-shift-for-apac-ai-workloads>

Company News

Fastly

Mon, Aug 24, 2026

Fastly Next-Gen WAF Dashboard Data Outage Resolved After Same-Day Fix

Fastly reported a service incident on August 24, 2026 in which the Next-Gen WAF (NGWAF) dashboard showed blank or missing performance data for some customers. WAF protection and all other Fastly products remained fully operational; only dashboard visibility was affected. Engineers identified a contributing factor and deployed a fix the same day, after which dashboard data began backfilling with data integrity confirmed and no data loss.

Source: <https://isdown.app/status/fastly/incidents/643238-performance-issues-with-dashboard-data>

Security Advisory

Citrix (NetScaler)

Mon, Aug 24, 2026

Security Experts Urge Priority Patching of Latest NetScaler ADC and Gateway Vulnerability

Security researchers escalated calls for urgent patching of newly disclosed NetScaler ADC and NetScaler Gateway flaws, warning that exploitation is expected. CVE-2026-19490 is a critical authentication bypass (CVSS 9.3) affecting appliances configured as AAA virtual servers or Gateway (SSL VPN, ICA Proxy, CVPN, RDP Proxy), while CVE-2026-19489 is a memory overflow DoS tied to SIP ALG in Large Scale NAT configurations. Customer-managed deployments must upgrade to fixed builds 14.1-73.32 or 13.1-63.21 and later.

Source: <https://www.cyberdaily.au/security/14088-patch-now-experts-urge-priority-patching-of-latest-citrix-netscaler-adc-and-netscaler-gateway-vulnerability>

Research/Report

A10 Networks

Mon, Aug 24, 2026

Analysts Weigh A10 AI Gateway Launch Against Stretched Valuation

Analyst coverage assessed A10 Networks following general availability of the A10 AI Gateway, unveiled at Black Hat USA 2026 as a centralized control plane for routing, cost management, governance, observability, and security across enterprise AI agents, applications, and LLMs. The commentary framed the launch as a credible growth driver supporting A10's raised 2026 guidance, while flagging valuation risk: shares traded at \$26.12 versus a \$34.80 fair-value estimate, but at a 44.1x P/E well above the software industry average.

Source: <https://simplywall.st/stocks/us/software/nyse-aten/a10-networks/news/a10-networks-aten-launches-ai-gateway-as-fair-value-stays-in>

Research/Report

Arista Networks

Mon, Aug 24, 2026

Arista Purchase Commitments Nearly Triple to \$9.7 Billion on AI Networking Demand

Analysis published August 24, 2026 highlighted that Arista Networks has sharply increased its multiyear purchase commitments, which reached roughly \$9.7 billion at the end of Q2 2026 — nearly triple the level a year earlier. The buildup signals aggressive supply pre-positioning for AI networking demand well beyond current visibility, following Arista's first \$3 billion quarter and 40% growth guidance. The report frames the commitments as a bet on sustained AI fabric orders, with inventory and margin risk if hyperscaler and neocloud demand slows.

Source: <https://www.trefis.com/stock/anet/articles/612580/arista-networks-is-buying-further-ahead-than-it-can-see/2026-08-24>

Company News

HPE / Juniper Networks

Mon, Aug 24, 2026

University of Leeds Selects HPE Self-Driving Network for Campus-Wide Modernization

The University of Leeds selected the HPE Self-Driving Network to modernize its campus-wide wired and wireless infrastructure as part of a broader digital transformation. The deployment is built on the HPE Mist platform and combines HPE Networking EX switches, HPE Juniper Networking QFX switches, and HPE Mist access points, integrated with HPE Marvis to deliver a unified AIOps experience across core, distribution, and edge. The win is an early proof point for combined HPE-Juniper portfolio selling after the acquisition closed.

Source: <https://newsinthechannel.co.uk/university-of-leeds-selects-hpe-self-driving-network/>

Research/Report

HPE / Juniper Networks

Mon, Aug 24, 2026

Analysis Warns Enterprises to Reassess Leverage After HPE-Juniper Consolidation

A published analysis of the HPE-Juniper consolidation argued the combined portfolio expands technology options but reshapes enterprise negotiating dynamics. While a single broader supplier can simplify operations, it raises dependency risk if commercial terms limit future flexibility. Enterprises are advised to reassess supplier alternatives and channel strategies, probe roadmap and integration commitments early, and structure portfolio deals with options to unwind or adjust parts of the estate later.

Source: <https://www.lb3law.com/blog/hpe-juniper-what-network-consolidation-means-for-enterprise-leverage/>

Research/Report

Barracuda Networks

Mon, Aug 24, 2026

Barracuda Research Finds Average Web App Carries 20 Vulnerabilities

Barracuda Networks published analysis showing the average web application contains roughly 20 vulnerabilities, with nearly half tied to information disclosure or brand impersonation/spoofing risk. Seven categories account for about 90% of findings, most stemming from basic misconfigurations rather than exotic exploits. Barracuda urges teams to use AI to proactively discover and remediate flaws, tighten DevSecOps collaboration on patching externally facing apps, and warns attackers increasingly chain multiple low-severity flaws into meaningful breaches.

Source: <https://securityboulevard.com/2026/08/barracuda-networks-analysis-finds-20-vulnerabilities-on-average-per-web-app/>